

Trial by Fire

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(Edited by Samuel J. Wood in 2026)



I have tried my best to make this obvious inside the game, but I'm sure that someone will find it unclear along the way. If you fall into this category don't sweat it. To be honest, I have tried to let you bend around in this game with only a loose chronology to what comes first, second, and so forth.

Damarias

The main point in Trial by Fire is to escape from the Oobleck by finding Damarias. Who is Damarias? Well now, that's quite a story. When the gods fashioned the worlds of the Realmz they didn't exactly do everything the neatest or best way. Hey, they were down right sloppy. Everything was totally out of balance and none of the gods

could get their creations to work. So together they created Damarias (sometimes said Dumarias.) This creature devoured all of their mistakes. It could destroy anything. They basically used Damarias as their eraser, fixing things here and there until the worlds began to function as they wanted.

Only, once things got to working, well, Damarias became a bit of a bother. The beast's appetite was insatiable. The gods began to fear Damarias, thinking that someday it would devour them as well. To stave off this fate, they created the Oobleck, a place to forget about all their mistakes, especially Damarias.

The Oobleck

The only problem was, the gods remembered the Oobleck. They began to use it after the creation, occasionally sticking inconvenient mountains in, or the odd lake that seemed to interfere with the construction of a perfectly lovely (or hideous) temple, or people. Whenever a non-god would begin to rise in power beyond the comfort level of the gods, one of them would get the bright idea of just sort of making them disappear.

Slowly the Oobleck became populated by powerful beings who lived, loved, hated, fought, and died in this other world.

The Dragon Child

A legend really, the gods were required by the laws that existed before they did to make a way out for Damarias. One day, as the legend goes, powerful beings would find their way to the Oobleck and the Dragon Child would be born at their touch.

The rest of the legend was purposefully obscured by the gods to limit the chance that anyone would free Damarias (hey, if you know the rules you know how to get around them.) The part that remains in rumors and song, however, is that those who wake the dragon child must face Damarias.

Amanda

Long ago, before Bywater or even Waterford, a great King ruled the lands of the Realmz. This King was proud of his many accomplishments as were the gods. They made him and his house immortal. Two daughters were born to the King and his wife, Elsa and Amanda. Both girls were beautiful and strong, but it was Amanda who turned the heads of all the knights.

The King knew that, because of their immortality, Amanda's heart would be broken as she watched any man she loved age, wither, and die. As he feared, Amanda fell in love

with his greatest knight, Sir Lot. The King, wanting to show his daughter the folly of loving a mortal, commanded Sir Lot to ride out and face the seven dragons of the south. The King knew, as did Sir Lot, that it was a mission certain to lead to death.

Sir Lot agreed.

When Amanda discovered her father's treachery she pleaded first with him, then with Sir Lot. Neither man would move from the quest. Something in Amanda snapped and all goodness drained from her. Calling on all the gods of evil, Amanda made a pact with them, giving Sir Lot immortality but at the price of both of their freedom. Now the two are imprisoned in the Oobleck, never together, forever hating.

Elsa

With the disappearance of her sister, Elsa began to search. Her powers grew over the centuries of questing for her beloved sister, and bit by bit she unraveled what happened to Amanda. The gods saw this too, and fearing that their great secret be revealed, they cast Elsa into the Oobleck.

Dex

As the greatest hunter and archer in all the Realmz, Dex trailed Elsa to the temple at Brigsfont. His tracking skills were so adept that he was able to follow her path to the Oobleck. The gods once again grew concerned, and they sealed the path that Dex had taken leaving only the hope of the Dragon Child for freedom.

Once in the Oobleck, Dex found Elsa. He had been wounded a thousand times over in the journey, and death was imminent. Elsa, knowing that the young man loved her, slit her wrist and let her immortal blood mingle with the last drops of his. Dex was not only healed, he too became immortal. When the gods saw that immortality was granted by a non-god they were enraged. Their powers were tied, however, because the couple had already received their greatest punishment, eternity in prison with only one hope of escape.

And over time, hope fades.

Gimmes

ONLY READ THIS IF YOU'RE DESPERATE!!!!!!

The following information is provided only for those who would bother me with a ton of garbage e-mail begging for answers to a million inane questions, or for those who read the end of a mystery novel first.

I am providing this information against my will.

Go back before it's too late.

Okay, let's get on with it...

(These will be in no particular order because I am mean.)

- The gate out of Elsa's valley: SPEAK "friend." For those with a background in Tolkien, this one was obvious.
- The pass through the southern river : Let's see... something that some people drink. Not me. I'm LDS. And it's not coffee.
- Lot's Casket (the one you see someone moving inside of) : Go ahead and volunteer to take his place. He'll explain it, but it doesn't really cost you anything.
- Dragon Mountain Gates : You can get in by casting Transmute Other, Invisible Skin, or use the Dragon Hide Cloak. Any of the three works.
- The Secret door to Dragon Mountain : Hmmm. Nope, I don't want to give you this one. Just go into the garbage valley south of the southern town and hunt around. There's a map there and a clue to what you need.
- Elsa and Dex : get them as NPCs as soon as you can. Remember, they are immortal.
- There is a cave east of Dex's house. Go south through it and find the Giant's valley. I'm not going to tell you where, but there is a well in it. Make a wish and select one of four things (my favorite is the money one, but that's because I love the sound of characters dying in the morning.) If you do the Disney thing, you'll love the reward.

- In Amanda's house you will find a secret door behind her mirror. Go down and find her ex-husbands. Down further and you'll find the fiances that never quite made it. One particularly well decomposed corpse has my personal favorite treasure in the whole scenario. Get it. Use it. Love it.

- In Damarias' entry valley is an odd machine that speaks to you. The keys are images in the sands through the four caves (North, South East, and West in that order.) Someone has to touch the key image at each place. Hee, hee, hee....

- Just after the "Friend" gate is a cave leading south. Follow it to a small valley where a bunch of young thieves are trying to scrape out a living. They have a bunch of good treasure they are willing to sell cheap (the town fences won't buy their stuff.) Be sure and pick up the Dragon Skin Cloak.

- The Dragon Child Egg is in the central west of Dragon Mountain. As you might guess, it is paramount that you get the Dragon Child. Touch the egg. Don't let go. Touch the Dragon Child. It's that simple (although a bit painful so you might want to choose your character with the highest physical stamina.)

- The dragons do have a hoard. Check out the north western corner inside Dragon Mountain. There is a sub cave there. Now, if you'll remember, the sub cave would be directly under the lake outside Dragon Mountain. There are a bunch of chests. Why on earth would dragons put things into chests? Enough said?

- The only shops with Banking are in the barbaric but nice town and with Elsa. Well, I just can't be forced to say anything more! I won't do it, do you hear me? So there!!!

Well, that's all folks. I hope you have fun with this adventure. Take it from me, even a little adventure like this one takes hours and hours of labor.

-Dusty

p.s.

Look for The New Heaven Saga in bookstores Winter of 1998. You know, its one of those manual things, a book. If you love your science with a little fiction, you'll love this one.

(Forgive the plug.)

